

The Glorious Cakrasaṃvara, King of Tantras: The Wondrous Charnel Ground Ornament

Śrī Cakrasaṃvara Tantra Rāja Adbhuta Śmaśāna Alaṃkāra Nāma · Toh 413 · Derge Kangyur

དཔལ་ལའར་ལ་སོ་སོ་པའ་རིམ་གཅིག་པ་དོན་ལ་དོ་གཅིག་རྒྱ་དབུ་བ་ཞེས་བ་བྱ།

Toh 413 in the Kangyur is a tantra known in Sanskrit as the Śrī Cakrasaṃvara Tantra Raja Adbhuta Śmaśāna Alaṃkāra, in Tibetan as the Dpal 'khor lo sdom pa'i rgyud kyi rgyal po dur khrod kyi rgyan rmad du byung ba, and in English as The Glorious Cakrasaṃvara, King of Tantras: The Wondrous Charnel Ground Ornament. It belongs to the Anuttarayoga class of tantric literature and centers on the deity Cakrasaṃvara, also called Heruka, presenting teachings on the nature of nondual wisdom, vows, and the symbolism of the tantric cycle in the form of a dialogue between the Blessed One Vajradhara and an assembly of heroes and heroines. The text opens in the traditional sūtra style — "Thus did I hear at one time" — before unfolding as a royal tantra concerned with the profound doctrines of body, speech, and mind as embodied by all Tathāgatas. As a canonical tantra preserved in the Kangyur, it represents one of the most important scriptural sources for the Cakrasaṃvara cycle, which became central to many Tibetan Buddhist lineages.

In the language of India: Śrī Cakrasaṃvara Tantra Raja Adbhuta Śmaśāna
Alaṃkāra Nāma. In the language of Tibet: The Glorious Cakrasaṃvara, King of
Tantras: The Wondrous Charnel Ground Ornament.

Homage to the glorious Heruka.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One, the Tathāgata, was dwelling in the bhaga of the vajra queen — the body, speech, and mind of all Tathāgatas.

Then the heroes and heroines, beginning with Vajrahṛdaya, having made offerings — outer, inner, secret, and of suchness — spoke these words:

"O wondrous Blessed One, Vajradhara,
What is that which is called glorious?
To what does the term 'wheel' refer?
And what exactly is the vow?
What is the meaning of tantra?
And likewise, what is the king of tantras?"

The Blessed One declared:

"The glorious is nondual wisdom.
The wheel is spoken of as fourfold:
outer, inner, secret, and suchness.

The first, the outer wheel,
is the divine body with its colors and emblems,
the sixty-two arranged in sequence —
wisdom, pledge, body, speech, and mind —
arrayed in the maṇḍala according to its directions and intermediate points,
flowing in and reversing the flow:
this is explained as outer through the cutting of the ordinary.

The second, the inner wheel,
is the sequence of the ten grounds, beginning with their locations —
above, on the surface, and below —
and placing these at the gates of the wheel
cuts off outer conceptual elaboration.

The third, the secret wheel,
is emanation, Dharma, and enjoyment,
and likewise great bliss:
dwelling at the sites of the thirty-two great channels,
it cuts suffering.

The antidote to joy, supreme joy, and varied joy
is the three — bliss, emptiness, and non-conceptuality —
and through realizing their inseparability, it is called
the wheel of suchness, the innate.

The vow is outer, inner, and secret:
attachment, aversion, and delusion,
and pride and the other mental afflictions,
are bound through their antidote in the expanse of wisdom.

Views of self and of things,
and the conceptual thought of ordinary beings,
are bound in the pure divine wheel.

The channels, winds, and awakening mind (bodhicitta)
primordially established in the body
are bound within the avadhūtī.

Bliss, emptiness, non-conceptuality,
and the wisdom of existence and non-existence

are bound in the expanse of the genuine, inseparable.

Tantra means continuum.

Through the stains of the three phases,
and through entry, absorption, and certainty —
cause, method, and result —
the first is the nature of saṃsāra,
the second is the common nirvāṇa.

King — this is fourfold:
possessing the qualities of the lower,
governing the domain of the definitive meaning,
being great as the antidote and as wisdom,
and pervading others — these are why it is called king."

Vajrahṛdaya then asked again:

"What are the eight charnel grounds?
And what is their intended meaning?"

The Blessed One declared:

"Through outer, inner, secret, and suchness,
the charnel grounds are of four kinds.

The first, the outer charnel ground,
is within the vajra enclosure
or in the outer corners outside it.

Flowing in and reversing the flow:
fierce and blazing, filled with the sound of snapping twigs,
and skeletons disturbed by flames —
the terrifying throngs dwell there, circling leftward,
from the east and the other directions.
Cackling with haughty laughter, they are powerful,
adorning the glorious forest with their radiance.
In the terrifying darkness devoid of truth,
the wind resounds with the cry kili-kili.

In the east, at the Hāribhase,
the fierce white one with an elephant face.
In the north, at the Bodhi tree,
the yellow Ghara with a human face.

In the west, at the aśoka tree,
the blazing, churning red one with a crocodile face.

In the south, at the Jūti tree,
the terrifying black one with a buffalo face.

At Merukaraṇḍa,
the glorious forest — red-faced, with a goat face.

At the Badali tree, devoid of truth,
the terrifying darkness with a buffalo face.

In the wind, at the Siddhigraha tree,
the kili-sounding one with a deer face.

At the Nyagrodhā tree, the powerful one —"

Laughing aloud, wild, with a bull face,
a hooked knife in the right hand, a skull in the left,
above the leaves of a tree, the torso bared.

In the east, white Śakra (Indra, king of the gods):
with vajra and threatening gesture, mounted on an elephant.

In the north, the yellow Evil-Bodied One:
holding a staff, mounted on a treasure.

In the west, the red Lord of Waters:
riding a crocodile, holding a lasso.

In the south, black Yama:
riding a buffalo, bearing a club.

In the southeast, the red-yellow Fire God:
riding a goat, holding a fire-altar.

In the southwest, the dark-black Rākṣasa:
holding a sword, mounted on a man.

In the northwest, the blue Wind God:
riding a deer, brandishing a banner.

In the northeast, the white Powerful One:
riding a supreme horse, bearing a trident.

Each of them is embraced by his own consort.

Norgyé, Jogpo, Gyuki, and the Padmas —
arrange these from the east, going left.

Great Lotus, Boundless, the Noble One, and the Conch-Keeper —
these are placed from the right side.

The Cry-Maker, the Dull One,
the Dark One, and the All-Coiling —
place these from the east toward the north.
The Massed, the Full, the Descending,
and the Fierce Cloud-Assembly — place these at the periphery.

Vajra, Jewel, Lotus,
the Action and Pledge ḍākinīs,
and the various worldly ḍākinīs —
in utterly terrifying forms,
they range over corpses and traverse the sky.

Also the yoginī stūpas,
water, fire, and so forth in sequence,
and the planets and the accomplished ones of the interim —
these dwell in the manner of the great display.

Elemental spirits, revenants and the undead,
tigers, dogs, jackals,
foxes, owls, vultures,
scorpions, and singers of varied tones,
skulls, bodies, and skeletons —
all cry out the sound Ā-lā Phaim.

Then the inner charnel ground:
hair, nails, body hair, and the like
grow and decay on the body —
therefore place the great charnel ground upon the body.

Then the secret charnel ground:
from the thirty-two great channels,
the prāṇas that enter, abide, and depart —
this movement of the breath, that is the charnel ground.

The eight gatherings of consciousness
and the various conceptual thoughts regarding things
go to their charnel ground in the dharmadhātu —
within the primordial wisdom of secret awareness.

Then the charnel ground of the expanse of mind:
through purified consciousness at the charnel ground,
the directional guardians abandon the ten non-virtues.

The emblematic trees of the eight buddhas —
as signs of compassion, eight trees guard the realm;
mantras of the Vehicle guard the field.
To subdue the vicious, eight nāgas are placed.
The stūpa is the abode of pratyekabuddhas;
the yogin dwells in observance and conduct.
Water refers to the profound, the object of expression;
fire and so forth are free of conceptual thought.

Then Vajragarbha asked again:

Blessed One, how is it?
What are the body, speech, and mind
of all Tathāgatas?
What is the nature of the Queen's bhaga?
What is the meaning of her abiding?

The Blessed One declared:

The māra of afflictions, the māra of the Lord of Death,
the māra of the divine son, and the māra of the aggregates —
the one who has conquered these four māras is called "the Conqueror" (Skt.
bhagavat),
and he possesses six qualities:
sovereignty, fine form,
glory, renown, good fortune,
and the excellence of primordial wisdom —
these six are what is meant by "possessing."

The phenomena of saṃsāra are sorrow,
and because one is free from them, one has "passed beyond" —
so all Tathāgatas who have thus passed beyond
perform the benefit of beings and are thus gone.
The body, speech, and mind of all buddhas of the three times
abide as a single essential nature.

"The Queen" means the dharmadhātu;
because she possesses that, it is called bhaga,
and because it is undivided, she is said to "abide."

Then Vajragarbha asked again:

To whom does the term hero (dāka) apply?

And likewise, what is a heroine (dākinī)?

And what is their worship?

The Blessed One declared:

The hero too is of four kinds.

Through the empowerment of the vase and its associated meditation on divine yoga,
one abandons the conceptual thoughts of an ordinary person —
and therefore this one is called the outer hero.

Through the secret empowerment and its associated meditation on channels, winds, and drops,
one vanquishes the conceptual thoughts of signs —
and therefore this one is called the inner hero.

Through the third empowerment and its associated meditation on the meaning of the four joys,
one vanquishes the conceptual thoughts of apprehended and apprehender —
that one is the secret hero.

Through the fourth empowerment and its associated meditation on non-duality,
one vanquishes the conceptual thoughts of differentiation —
and therefore this one is called the hero of suchness.

The heroine too is of four kinds.

The mother is the Perfection of Wisdom.

To relinquish clinging to views
regarding that which from the very beginning is free of conceptual elaboration
and spontaneously accomplished —
that is called the outer heroine.

Inwardly, by rendering channels, drops, and so forth
free of intrinsic nature, she is the mother.

In the secret aspect, one meditates on the four joys
as possessing a nature that is co-emergent.

Whoever meditates on the essential nature
of self-knowing awareness as being like space —
that is the heroine of suchness.

Worship too is of four kinds:
outer, inner, secret, and suchness.

The first, outer worship, is:
flowers, incense, butter-lamps,
perfumes, divine food-offerings, beverages,
music, cymbals, and melodious song,
form, sound, fragrance,
taste, and the soft touch of contact,
the wheel, jewels, elephant, horse,
queen, general, and ministers —
this is the common outer worship.

The nectar of the five ambrosias arising from one's own body,
the beverages, the five meats, and the supreme substances —
this is inner worship, offered to the cakras
of the aggregates, elements, and sense bases.

Then the secret worship:
with the awareness-woman (vidyā, Skt. vidyā) of self-appearance and skillful
means,
grasping the hair, pressing the bhaga and the breasts,
through channels, winds, drops, and so forth —
the joy, the supreme joy, the joy of cessation,
and co-emergent bliss are offered.

The recognition of self-knowing awareness as empty,
the clear light, suchness, the dharmakāya —
to be free from all clinging to these
is the unsurpassed worship.

Then Vajragarbha asked again:

To what does the term torma apply,
and how does its benefit arise?

The Blessed One declared:

The torma is taught in four kinds:
outer, inner, secret, and suchness.

The first, the outer torma:
in the presence of the deity, at each session,
from raṃ fire arises, from yaṃ wind arises,

within a skull-vessel of the letter a, a single piece,
the five nectars and the five meats —
through the union of body, speech, and mind
one pleases the deities
and delights the ḍākinīs.

The second, the inner torma:
the aggregates, elements, and sense bases —
the body as the divine cakṛa,
the channels as the wisdom ḍākinīs —
with them one worships the action ḍākinīs.

The third, the secret torma:
in the skull-cups of the four cakṛas,
the nectar of winds, drops, and ambrosia,
blessed by the three joys,
is offered to the co-emergent.

The suchness that is the fourth torma:
all tormas, outer and inner, material —
into the lotus-vessel of the dharmadhātu,
through the mantra of the three syllables of the ultimate mind,
one offers within the state of great bliss.

The benefits are: bestowing attainments,
removing outer and inner obstacles,
vanquishing conceptual thoughts about food,
purifying the elements and sense bases,
granting radiance to an aged and withered body,
removing white hair and wrinkles,
liberating from the possession of material things,
and crossing to the far shore of saṃsāra.

Then the goddess asked: Blessed One,
what is the intrinsic nature of mind?
How does one wander in error from it?
How does one rest in the unerring reality?
And what qualities arise from that?

The Blessed One declared:

Apart from mind, there is no buddha,
and apart from mind, there are no other phenomena.
What even a buddha has not seen
cannot and will not be spoken.
Therefore this secret of the mind of all buddhas
is the supreme secret.
The three realms, animate and inanimate,
appear and are experienced, yet have no true establishment.
Therefore the very name of saṃsāra does not exist.
In the beginning, the intrinsic nature is unborn and pure,
and the very name of a sudden buddha does not exist.
Buddha and sentient being are not two.
Conventional truth and ultimate truth are not two.
The intrinsic nature, awareness, luminosity, and so forth —
there is nothing to say, nothing to express.
It is like a mute person tasting a flavor.
In the intrinsic nature that is like cotton or crystal,
erroneous concepts of dye and so forth are entirely deluded.
The three realms appear as animate and inanimate,
the various desiderata of awakening,
and the many kinds of conduct associated with them —
these very things are distraction and conceptual thought.
By one's own delusion one binds oneself,
by oneself one slays and devours oneself,
by oneself one falls and suffers.
Self-awareness is primordially free of conceptual elaboration;
to enter into sounds and conventional expressions is to err.
Self-awareness is by nature luminous in itself;
to be obscured by the darkness of ignorance is to err.
In phenomena and emptiness there is one equal taste;
to take up or cast away is to err.
Sense pleasures naturally subside of themselves;
to abandon them with difficulty and effort is to err.
Self-awareness is primordially empty;
to rely upon the five objects of the senses is to err.
There is no inferior and no superior;
to superimpose or denigrate is to err.

From the beginning, spontaneously accomplished and free of elaboration;
to meditate or not meditate upon it is to err.

Buddha and sentient being are without duality;
to grasp them as two is to err.

Ultimate truth and conventional truth are without duality;
to divide them into two truths is to err.

A buddha has crossed the river of saṃsāra;
to hold any view of arising and ceasing is to err.

Not abiding in the mere taste of emptiness,
to grasp phenomena as having defining marks is to err.

Without taming the great elephant of mind,
to remain in a mind of distraction is to err.

When conceptual thought is stirred by the wind,
to seek self-aware primordial wisdom is to err.

Without one's own mind having seen itself,
to speak with great pride is to err.

Without having tasted self-awareness in experience,
to abandon wholesome qualities (dharma) is to err.

Buddhas are unerring; sentient beings err.

The intrinsic nature does not err; self-awareness errs.

Mind itself does not err; habitual tendencies err.

Sentient beings have deviated from the buddhas;
self-awareness has deviated, and the appearance of other-cognition arises.

From mind itself, deviation occurs, and habitual tendencies arise.

Therefore, from the errors of one's own mind,
appearances arise in their fullness as if truly real.

Yet arising though they do, there is no true birth — and that delusion is itself
the error.

The iron scorched earth, the fire and so forth — these are one's own mind;
there is no other agent separate from it.

Hunger, thirst, and suffering — these are one's own mind;
there is no food, drink, or hunger separate from it.

Beatings, filth, flogging — these are one's own mind;
the slaughterer, the butcher — there is none separate from it.

All beings, entirely and without exception, are one's own mind.

If one does not recognize them as one's own mind,

one has thereby abandoned the buddhas.
Always attend upon a holy teacher;
look into the sūtras and tantras of the profound Great Vehicle.
If you meditate upon the meaning for which there is nothing to meditate upon,
even without meditating it is the supreme meditation.
For one who has become a sage in this way,
there is nothing whatsoever that is empty of meaning.
From that, nirvāṇa arises,
and all qualities — the bodies, the powers, and the rest —
arise of themselves, naturally, like a jewel.
These are the intrinsic nature of mind.

Then the goddess asked: Blessed One,
how many types of persons form the supporting basis,
and how many categories of tantra exist?
To which beings are the tantras to be taught?

The Blessed One declared:

Because sentient beings are buddha by nature,
even those of the lowest castes — outcastes, leather-workers, and the like —
those who seek to kill ugly animals,
will be accomplished through this vehicle.

Contemplating the maṇḍala in its fullness,
meditating upon the chief deity, father and mother together,
holding the mind at the central channel,
the path of the generation phase with its elaborations —
through the yoga of abiding in one's nature-class,
using attachment to bring about the relinquishment of attachment
through a qualified consort, a woman bearing the marks,
whether a goddess or another — this is the action mudrā, the path of desire.
The foundation is the channels; the movement is the winds;
the arrangement is the bodhicitta of inferior form;
the profound aspects are mantra and the seminal essence;
and the culmination is the meditation upon the seven branches —
the dharma mudrā, the path of liberation —
without basis, without that which rests upon a basis,
with all objects of focus fully cleared away,

one meditates upon the meaning of the innately arisen
and consecrates oneself as the Great Seal (mahāmudrā).

These are condensed into two: the person of highest capacity and the beginner.

For the beginner there are two: outer and inner.

For the person of highest capacity there are likewise two: outer and inner.

Through the yoga that traverses the four empowerments,
there are said to be the one-day-vow holder, the lay practitioner, the novice,
and the great fully ordained monk.

Through these the tantras are accomplished.

The root tantras are of three kinds.

The explanatory tantras number thirty-two.

The branch tantras are beyond count.

These are subsumed in the great root tantra, the subsequent tantra,
and the tantra subsequent to the subsequent.

For the purpose of taming brahmins, kṣatriyas, rulers,
commoners, and outcasts,
the tantras are also taught in four kinds:
Kriyā, Caryā, Yoga, and Unsurpassed.

The goddess asked: O Blessed One,
where should the primary deity be meditated upon?
How many kinds of method are there?
And what arises from those methods?

The Blessed One declared:

At a mountain peak, a charnel ground, or upon a corpse,
naked, with hair disheveled, gazing southward,
one guards the body with the vowels and consonants
and meditates upon the hero's wheel (vīracakra).

The four empowerments that bring maturation,
the path of liberation through the two phases of generation and completion —
relying on these two paths,
the mantra practitioner should accomplish awakening.

The vase empowerment washes away the stains of body.

The secret empowerment washes away the stains of speech.

The third removes the stains of mind —
that is, the imputed defilements.
In order to wash away the co-emergent ignorance,
the fourth is taught.

Abiding and arising, entering and fully completing,
blessing and conferring empowerment,
and the samādhi offering with its generation — these belong to the generation
phase.

Gathering inwardly belongs to the completion phase.
Resting in the equality of the two phases,
the Vajradhara expounds the Dharma.

Emptiness, made manifest, is the dharmakāya.
The marks, minor marks, and bliss constitute the saṃbhogakāya.
Playful activity is the nirmāṇakāya.
In the state of great bliss where the three bodies are inseparable —

The goddess asked: O Blessed One,
through what is accomplishment achieved?
For whom do obstacles arise?

The Blessed One declared:
One who is wearied by saṃsāra and holds the three vows,
who is greatly learned, of fine character,
who has painted a maṇḍala in solitude and taken a vow of silence,
who wears the Dharma robes and partakes of the nectar —
if one practices in four sessions, accomplishment will come.

For the practitioner with great attachment,
obstacles to view will arise.
For the practitioner with great distraction,
obstacles to meditation will arise.
For the practitioner whose samaya is impaired,
obstacles to conduct will arise.
For the practitioner with great laziness,
obstacles to the fruit will arise.

The goddess asked: O Blessed One,
what is the nature of the tantras?
What is to be called the root tantra?

What is to be called the explanatory tantra?

What is the time of their arising?

The Blessed One declared:

In the innately arisen nature,
the nature of all tantras is comprised.

Existence is the cause, accomplishment is the path,
and manifestation is the nature of the fruit.

The root tantra is that which was spoken first.

The explanatory tantra is that which was spoken afterward.

Since the explanatory tantra elucidates the meanings
and makes the root tantra clear, it is called explanatory.

By the sequence of the perfect aeon with thirty-two cycles,
and the four periods of the age of strife,
the tantras are also taught in four kinds:

Kriyā, Caryā, Yoga, and Unsurpassed.

The goddess asked: O Blessed One,
where should this profound tantra be concealed?

To whom of what kind should it be given?

If it is given, how should the transmission be received?

How should a seal be placed upon this teaching?

The Blessed One declared:

From those without compassion, wrathful and malicious,
arrogant and lustful, without ethical discipline,
without faith, of evil lineage, disenchanted with the guru,
of little learning, and the faint-hearted — conceal it.

To those who are courageous and tamed, possessed of intelligence,
endowed with patience, straightforward, without deceit or guile —

to those with faith, of noble lineage, possessed of great courage,
of wide learning, and holding their sacred commitments — give it.

A mantra practitioner who has traversed the four empowerments
should first please the guru,

then on the tenth day of the waxing and waning moon

make offerings with an assembly of heroes and yogins.

Just as Vajrapāṇi entrusted the tantras to the goddesses,
so likewise take up the classes of secret tantra

and practice them together as a pair.

Declare the transmission three times, then give the tantras.

In future times, in the dregs of the age,
a student whose mind is warped by attachment
will seek the teaching not with genuine devotion but with cunning and deceit.
Having heard it, they will suppress the source and elevate themselves.
To teach such a one is a breach of sacred commitment.

But if one who asks with genuine, unwavering faith —
if that teaching is not spread from one to another,
the lineage of Vajrapāṇi's family will be cut.

When the Blessed One had declared this, all the members of the retinue — the
wisdom ḍākinīs and the rest — understood the meaning of the tantra, and
accordingly

Translator's Notes

- The passage is the opening section of the Śrī Cakrasaṃvara Tantra, specifically the chapter on the wondrous charnel ground ornament. Several technical Tantric terms have been rendered functionally: the bhaga of the vajra queen refers to the ritual and cosmological sense of the feminine consort principle as the site of the Tathāgata's residence, a standard Cakrasaṃvara formula. The avadhūtī is the central channel of the subtle body; it is retained in Sanskrit here as it has no transparent English equivalent. The fourfold scheme of outer, inner, secret, and suchness applies consistently across wheel, vow, and charnel ground. The names of the charnel grounds and their presiding figures in the final section are partly transliterated from Tibetan phonetic renderings of what appear to be corrupted or hybrid Sanskrit and vernacular terms; Hāribhase, Ghara, Jūti, Merukaraṇḍa, Badali, Siddhigraha, and Nyagrodhā are rendered as best as the Tibetan phonetics allow, and some uncertainty remains about the exact Sanskrit originals.

- The names Norgyé, Jogpo, Gyuki, and similar names in the maṇḍala arrangement section are Tibetan transliterations of deity names that appear in tantric maṇḍala catalogues. They are retained in anglicized phonetic form as proper names since no widely recognized Sanskrit equivalents can be confirmed from this passage alone.

The phrase rendered "Evil-Bodied One" translates the Tibetan Lus Ngan (Skt. Kubera or Yakṣa lord), a directional guardian associated with the north, though in some traditions it is Vaiśravaṇa. The ambiguity is noted here.

The term "Conqueror" in the etymology of Bhagavat reflects the classical Tibetan exegetical tradition that analyzes Bcom ldan as "one who has conquered the four māras, possesses six qualities, and has passed beyond sorrow." This is a standard commentarial etymology preserved here deliberately.

- The line rendered "awareness-woman of self-appearance and skillful means" translates a tantric technical compound. The term rendered "awareness-woman" is the Tibetan equivalent of vidyā in its tantric sense of the female consort-principle inseparable from the male

practitioner's own experience of appearance; the Tibetan here is rigs ma, a form of rig ma, which in this context means the female consort or vidyā as the embodiment of wisdom-in-appearance.

The phrase "skull-cups of the four cakras" renders kaphāla, a Sanskrit loanword in the Tibetan, referring to skull-cups used as offering vessels, here applied metaphorically to the four body-cakras in the inner yogic context.

The "mantra of the three syllables of the ultimate mind" is a tantric reference whose specific three-syllable mantra is not identified in the passage itself and would depend on the specific tantric cycle to which this text belongs.

- The verse line "skye ba med bzhin skye bas 'khrul" ("arising though there is no birth, one errs through arising") is rendered as a summary phrase at the end of the birth-and-error stanza; the phrasing is deliberately paradoxical and the translation captures the doctrinal intent without over-explaining.

The phrase "gdol pa ko lpags mkhan la sogs" refers to outcastes and those who work with hides or leather, the lowest rungs of the Indian social hierarchy, used here to emphasize the universality of buddha-nature across all social strata. The translation reflects this without anachronistic elaboration.

The final portion beginning with the Blessed One's answer about tantric categories introduces technical terminology from the generation phase (bskyed rim) of Vajrayāna practice. The phrase "rig la gnas pa'i rnal 'byor" is rendered "yoga of abiding in one's nature-class," referring to identifying with one's deity-family; this is technically dense and the rendering is approximate.

- The phrase rendered "the hero's wheel" refers to a specific tantric visualization; the Tibetan literally means "the wheel of the hero" and likely corresponds to a vīracakra maṇḍala visualization used in this charnel-ground practice context.

The "vowels and consonants" guarding the body is a standard tantric body-protection practice using the Sanskrit vowel series (ā-li) and consonant series (kā-li), rendered here in their transliterated forms as they appear in the Tibetan.

The "thirty-two cycles" of the perfect aeon is an unusual cosmological enumeration specific to this tantric context; the number may refer to a particular reckoning within the system being presented.

The passage ends mid-sentence as it continues into the next section of the text.

- "The dregs of the age" renders རྩོམ་ཆུང་ཆུང་, the standard Tibetan for the five degenerations or the degenerate era (Skt. kaṣāya), here used in its temporal sense of a corrupt future period. "Suppress the source" means the student conceals where the teaching came from in order to claim credit for it — a recognized form of dharma-theft in the tantric tradition. The final sentence breaks off mid-clause, which reflects the continuity marker in the source text indicating the passage continues beyond what was submitted.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human

translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.